

FIXING THE LEAKS, FINDING THE GOALS

From leaky defence to goal droughts, India women's hockey **faces a stern** Asia Cup test as it targets a World Cup return.

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A muggy Bengaluru afternoon had given way to a cool evening, a light drizzle speckling the azure blue turf at the Sports Authority of India (SAI) centre. The Indian women's hockey players were split into two different-coloured vests, simulating match scenarios in an intra-squad game devised by analytical coach Dave Smolenaars and head coach Harendra Singh.

"If I speak about today's session, we were working on transitions. When we retrieve the ball, we are practising



K. MURALI KUMAR